Stoke City Football Club Limited

REPORT AND FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

31 May 2025

Company Registration No. 00099885

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Stoke City Football Club Limited
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Stoke City Football Club Limited
COMPANY INFORMATION

DIRECTORS
JF Coates – Chair
RK Smith – Vice Chair
P Coates

SECRETARY
DT Heath

REGISTERED OFFICE
bet365 Stadium
Stanley Matthews Way
Stoke-on-Trent
Staffordshire
ST4 4EG

AUDITOR
RSM UK Audit LLP
Chartered Accountants
Festival Way
Stoke-on-Trent
Staffordshire
ST1 5BB

The directors have pleasure in submitting their Strategic Report for Stoke City Football Club Limited ("the Club" or "the Company") for the year ended 31 May 2025.

BUSINESS/FINANCIAL REVIEW
The Club, once again, competed in the English Football League ("EFL") Championship in season 2024/25. The Company's Key Performance Indicators are summarised in the table below:-

	Championship 2025	Championship 2024
Average league attendance	**22,805**	22,517
Final league position	**18th**	17th
	£000's	£000's
Turnover	**35,438**	32,271
Operating expenses	**(65,143)**	(62,982)
Operating loss before player trading	**(22,189)**	(24,300)
Operating loss before player registration/fixed asset disposals	**(29,705)**	(30,711)
Profit on disposal of player registrations	**151**	4,407
Operating loss	**(29,537)**	(26,236)

The Company's turnover shown above is derived principally from gate revenue and central distributions from the EFL, as further demonstrated within note 2 of the accounts.

On 8 July 2024 Stoke City Holdings Limited and its subsidiaries were demerged from bet365 Group Limited to John Coates. All intragroup loans from the (now former) parent company of £90.5m were waived as part of this transaction leaving the Group debt free and the bet365 Stadium and Clayton Wood training facility were transferred to the ownership of Stoke City Holdings Limited.

Investment in the playing squad during the year continued with £7.3m (2024: £18.2m) spent on player registrations. In the Summer 2024 transfer window the Club realised profits on the disposal of the player registrations. A significant proportion of proceeds from these player sales were reinvested into the playing squad during the Summer 2024 and 2025 transfer windows. The Club continues to plan its player registration activity mindful of its need to ensure continued compliance with the EFL's Profitability and Sustainability regulations.

Turnover improved during the year to £35.4m (2024: £32.3m) as a consequence of increased EFL central distribution following the commencement of an improved broadcast contract with Sky and supported by improved underlying commercial revenues.

Operating losses including player transfers increased in the year principally as a consequence of reduced profits earned on the disposal of player registrations described above as well as an increase in operating expenses to £65.1m (2024: £63.0m) driven by property changes in the group. Note 5 shows that employment costs were £30.3m (2024: £31.8m) demonstrating the continuing constraint placed on the Club whilst operating under the EFL's Profitability and Sustainability Regulations.

The year saw the unveiling of plans and developments for Stoke City's women's and girls' football programme. A new Elite Girls' Academy programme has been established with a view to smoothing the pathway from the grassroots game, with the mission of significantly increasing the number of local girls being represented at the senior level.

BUSINESS AND FINANCIAL REVIEW (CONTINUED)

The programme includes a semi-professional women's first team; a paid women's development squad; and fully funded Academy girls' squads at U10s, U12s, U14s, and U16s. The Club will continue to support the FA's Emerging Talent Centre programme.

The plans reflect the significant investment in women and girl's football for the first time in 2024/25.

Net liabilities have increased to £158.0m (2024: £132.5m) as at 31 May 2025. The principal indebtedness, £145.9m (2024: £104.3m), is to Stoke City Holdings Limited.

RISKS AND UNCERTAINTIES

The Company's main risks and uncertainties centre around first-team performance and its direct impact on league status, position and ultimately revenue generation. Additional risks and uncertainties are, the ability to acquire, train and develop players to a sufficient standard so that the Club can return to the Premier League, together with any rise or fall in the valuation of these players.

Risks are periodically reviewed by the directors and appropriate processes and procedures are in place to monitor and mitigate them.

These areas include compliance with football financial regulations and the recruitment and retention of key employees.

FOOTBALL FINANCIAL REGULATIONS

In common with all Football Clubs in the EFL, the Club is annually assessed by the EFL for its compliance with financial regulations such as Profitability and Sustainability and Future Financial Information. The directors acknowledge these regulations and accordingly make prudent budget assumptions with regards to football performance that can impact on revenue generation such as matchday gate revenues and cup runs.

The directors review the Club's compliance with these financial regulations at the time of setting budgets and regularly throughout the football season to ensure continued compliance with them.

The directors have provided the EFL with their full support for the replacement of the Profitability and Sustainability Regulations with Squad Cost Ratio regulations which the directors regard as being more fit for purpose. On 21 November 2025, Premier League clubs voted to introduce Squad Cost Ratio regulations, replacing the current Profit and Sustainability rules from the start of the 2026/27 season. It would be logical for the EFL to adopt similar Squad Cost Ratio rules from 2026/27 season so as to ensure that the Championship does not stand alone as the only league in the top four divisions of English football operating under different financial rules. Adopting Squad Cost Ratio would ease the transition between leagues for all clubs.

On 21 July 2025 the Football Governance Act passed into law establishing the Independent Football Regulator. The directors will continue to monitor political developments in relation to the Independent Football Regulator with interest given its role overseeing financial regulation, including how this will coincide with existing financial regulations and the ability for owner's to commit sustainable investment in their club which the Club remain in favour of.

EMPLOYEES

Variations in the Company's financial results significantly depend on the performance of the Club's first team. The Company has well resourced recruitment and analysis departments to enable it to mitigate this risk and to be successful in this area. The Company operates a system of performance related pay for key personnel to support this strategy and mitigate this risk.

FINANCIAL INSTRUMENTS
The significant financial risks and exposures to the Company are in respect of liquidity and their effect on cashflow. The board manages these risks in order to minimise any adverse effects on the Company.

Liquidity
The Company's policy is to have facilities available from its ultimate owner to satisfy working capital requirements in the near to medium term as required.

Cash flow
Cash flow levels are continually monitored and reviewed to cover any foreseeable funding requirements with an allowance for unforeseen events.

Credit
Minimal credit is given by the Club, with the majority of sales being on a cash or cash equivalent basis. Season ticket sales with payment terms have been allowed and are outsourced by the Club to a third party. Any risk of bad debts is mitigated for player transfers through credit control procedures and close monitoring of cash receipts each month. Payment terms are given to other clubs based on contracts and these are closely monitored and managed appropriately by the Club.

STREAMLINED ENERGY AND CARBON REPORT
The Company was a direct subsidiary of Stoke City Holdings Limited at the year end which includes all relevant carbon reporting disclosures in its consolidated accounts. These disclosures include the reporting relevant for the Company, and as such the Company has applied the exemption given under the Companies Act 2006 Sch 7.20A (2) not to present this disclosure in its individual accounts.

SECTION 172 (1) STATEMENT
The directors recognise that effective engagement with stakeholders and consideration of their interests is fundamental to the success of the Company. The directors discharge their duties in accordance with Section 172 of the Companies Act 2006, which requires a director of a company to act in the way he or she considers, in good faith, would most likely promote the success of the Company for the benefit of its members as a whole. In doing this, section 172 requires directors to have regard, amongst other matters, to:

A. The likely consequences of any decisions in the long-term.

The Company's strategic decisions are made with the goal of fulfilling its ambition of playing at the highest level. The Company also takes decisions to ensure financial sustainability, and compliance with emerging regulatory frameworks, including the Independent Football Regulator. Investment in youth development, infrastructure, and community engagement are central to our long-term vision. Key decisions undertaken by the Board are documented on page 5 below.

The Company has worked within this code whilst fulfilling its ambition of playing at the highest level.

B. The interests of the Company's employees.

We refer to our Employee Engagement Statement on pages 8 and 9 which demonstrate that valuing its employees is central to the Company.

SECTION 172 (1) STATEMENT (CONTINUED)

C. The need to foster the Company's business relationships with suppliers, customers and others.

We refer to our Stakeholder Engagement Statement on page 6 which sets out our "partnership approach" to our stakeholders, where an emphasis is placed on the benefit to the business of long-term relationships.

D. The impact of the Company's operations on the community and environment.

We refer to our Stakeholder Engagement Statement. The Company has at all times and will continue to put the local community and environment at the heart of its business. A priority is placed on recruiting employees locally wherever possible, with a similar approach adopted with suppliers. This is reinforced through the work of Stoke City Foundation ("SCF"), formerly Stoke City Community Trust ("SCCT").

We refer to the Streamlined Energy and Carbon Reporting ("SECR") included within Stoke City Holdings Limited Financial Statements for further detail of how the Company has been working to reduce its carbon footprint.

E. The desirability of the Company maintaining a reputation for high standards of business conduct.

The Board uphold high standards of governance and ethical conduct. The Group complies with the EFL's Governance Code and is preparing in anticipation of the regulatory requirements of the Independent Football Regulator. Risk management and financial prudence are central to our decision-making.

F. The need to act fairly as between members of the Company.

The directors ensure that all decisions are made fairly and transparently, with consideration for the interests of all shareholders and stakeholders.

Following the change in ownership on 8 July 2024, the Company has retained the above standards of business conduct and is now in regular dialogue with its parent company's main shareholder, John Coates.

KEY DECISIONS
The directors are aware that, in common with virtually all clubs in the Championship, the Club will continue to operate with underlying annual financial losses unless and until:

- the Club is promoted back to the Premier League, which remains the directors' principal objective,
- the funding formula within English Football is changed to provide more income for clubs outside of the Premier League and/or
- further profits are made from player sales such that they balance the trading losses being incurred

In the absence of the above, the owner not only remains committed to fund the ongoing losses of the Club but also acknowledges the desirability to provide this funding through non-refundable, non-interest bearing share capital.

The directors are currently restricted from implementing their full plans for the Club as a result of the financial regulations implemented by the EFL in the Championship that currently prevent their use of sustainable investments that would otherwise be made. The directors remain committed to working within these restraints as required, but will continue to press for a change in the financial regulations to allow for sustainable investment by committed owners for the benefit of the Club and the local area.

KEY DECISIONS (CONTINUED)

The Club will, as previously, continue to engage with relevant stakeholders regards the development of an Independent Football Regulator and the promotion of the concept of sustainable owner investment realised through changes brought about by the Football Governance Bill, currently making its way through the legislative process. The Club will continue to engage with the EFL, Government and other stakeholders to pursue the successful realisation of this objective.

STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT STATEMENT
The following are considered to be the key stakeholders of the Company:

Stakeholder	Important areas for our key stakeholders and measures taken to demonstrate their value to the business and engagement are set out below:
Employees	Please see the Employee Engagement Statement in the Directors Report.
Suppliers	Business relationships are recognised by the directors as being essential to the continued success and positive reputation of the Company. The Company's staff are in regular contact with key commercial supporters and suppliers in order to ensure that the Club continues to promote strong and mutually beneficial relationships with its commercial partners.
Local Communities	Where possible and appropriate, use of local suppliers and local employees is encouraged to support the local economy in which we are located. The Club provides substantial support to SCF which continues to use the power and passion of the Club to transform lives in and around the Stoke on Trent and North Staffordshire areas by delivering a wide range of programmes to benefit local residents of all ages through physical and other activities supported by the Stoke City name. SCF's influence and reach allows it to make a positive difference to the health, wellbeing and life outcomes to those participants who engage in its programmes. The Club has embarked on a new mission whereby it is committed to getting Stoke on Trent and Staffordshire active, with the aim of further improving peoples' mental and physical wellbeing, and connecting our communities by bringing people together. The mission also aims to create sporting facilities in local communities which do not currently possess such amenity.
Supporters	Supporter engagement continues to evolve at the Club with an ever-increasing level of importance placed on it. The Club encourages more regular consultation with supporters across a larger range of topics through its Stoke City Connect programme. The Club targets growing its supporter base via a combination of affordable prices and programmes with local schools to encourage youngster attendance at first team games. Furthermore, the Company: o ensures our Stadium is fully accessible to disabled supporters, o provides free away coach travel to league matches, o has frozen the cost of season tickets for the past 17 seasons, o provides under 11 season tickets for £23, equivalent to £1 per match, o is investing in a purpose built Fanzone to improve the matchday experience for supporters and their families, o were voted EFL Family Club of the Year, o delivered a new crest via an entirely supporter-led consultation.

STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT STATEMENT (CONTINUED)

Football League	The Club's senior executive management meet regularly with the EFL and fellow member clubs to discuss matters common across all clubs.
Shareholders	The Club engages with its shareholders by regular meetings throughout the year, including on any key operational decisions.

By order of the board

John Coates
Chair

24/12/25

The directors submit their report and the financial statements of Stoke City Football Club Limited for the year ended 31 May 2025.

PRINCIPAL ACTIVITIES
The principal activity is that of a professional football club.

RESULTS AND DIVIDENDS
The loss for the year amounted to £25.5m (2024: £28.6m loss). The directors do not recommend the payment of preference or ordinary share dividends (2024: £nil).

DIRECTORS
The following directors have held office since 1 June 2024 and up to the date of signature of the financial statements:

JF Coates – Chair
RK Smith – Vice Chair
P Coates

EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT STATEMENT
Employees of the Company are key assets of the business. As a Company our policy is to demonstrate that all employees, regardless of role or seniority, feel an integral and valued part of our business. Employee satisfaction and involvement underpins the Club's strategic plan and the future success of the business.

We set high standards and our employees are expected to work to the best of their ability. This is reciprocated and reflected in the competitive salaries and extensive benefits packages we aim to offer our staff. The Company also places particular emphasis on equal pay for equal jobs and strictly adheres to the UK Modern Slavery Act. One of our core objectives is to be the 'employer of choice' within the local communities within which we operate.

Salaries and benefits are only part of the broader staff engagement factors. We also have a number of employee health and welfare programmes which target both physical and mental wellbeing. Our workplaces are, of course, designed to be safe and secure and our facilities and health and safety teams ensure the removal of any risk, albeit our operations are inherently low risk environments. The Company has policies to improve the overall employee experience including an additional day off on birthdays, an away game event and a preseason staff gathering.

The Company has always recognised that staff development and learning is an integral part of the organisation's strategic planning, equipping all staff with the knowledge and skills to perform their individual jobs effectively and in doing so ensure that the Company meets its strategic objectives.

Players are provided with a range of benefits and amenities to allow them to fulfil their potential as athletes. This includes support from qualified professionals in areas including football coaching, medical screening and rehabilitation, strength and conditioning, nutrition and sports psychology.

The Club's training facility at Clayton Wood provides players with a state-of-the-art facility in which to succeed, offering all-weather football pitches; strength, conditioning and rehabilitation equipment; and a modern refectory to meet all nutritional requirements.

Throughout the Club an extensive programme of both internal and external training and development is offered. During the period the training and development team offered workplace training for all employees as required for their roles. This was further supported by the utilisation of e-learning strategies and on-the-job training by dedicated coaches and instructors. Assessment and progression of staff careers are both transparent and rigorous.

EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT STATEMENT (CONTINUED)

Feedback from employees is obtained on an ongoing real-time basis through normal reporting channels, including up to the Company's Board where appropriate with actions undertaken in this regard.

The Company is an equal opportunities employer and operates a zero tolerance non-discrimination policy. This is reflected in our recruitment and selection processes, and continues throughout the employee's career in providing opportunities for training, further development and progression based entirely on individuals' skills and abilities, with adjustments made to accommodate disabilities. A major part of the Company's success has been based on its ability to identify, develop and promote talent from within the organisation.

The Company places considerable value on the involvement of its employees and has continued to keep them informed, via detailed HR communications, departmental management meetings and quarterly all-staff meetings, on matters affecting them as employees, and on the various factors affecting the performance of the Company.

POST BALANCE SHEET EVENTS
We refer to note 19 in respect of post balance sheet events.

STRATEGIC REPORT
In accordance with section 414C(11) of the Companies Act 2006 (Strategic Report and Directors' Report) Regulations 2013 the Company has chosen to set out in the Company's strategic report information required by schedule 7 of the Large and Medium-sized Companies and Groups (Accounts and Reports) Regulations 2008 to be contained in the directors report. It has done so in respect of financial instruments, future developments, stakeholder engagement and streamlined energy and carbon reporting.

STATEMENT AS TO DISCLOSURE OF INFORMATION TO THE AUDITOR
The directors have confirmed that, as far as they are aware, there is no relevant audit information of which the auditor is unaware. Each of the directors have confirmed that they have taken all the steps that they ought to have taken as directors in order to make themselves aware of any relevant audit information and to establish that it has been communicated to the auditor.

AUDITOR
RSM UK Audit LLP have indicated their willingness to be reappointed for another term and appropriate arrangements have been put in place for them to be deemed reappointed as auditors in the absence of an Annual General Meeting.

By order of the board

John Coates
Chair

24/12/25

Stoke City Football Club Limited

DIRECTORS' RESPONSIBILITIES IN THE PREPARATION OF FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

The directors are responsible for preparing the Strategic Report and the Directors' Report and the financial statements in accordance with applicable law and regulations.

Company law requires the directors to prepare financial statements for each financial year. Under that law the directors have elected to prepare the financial statements in accordance with United Kingdom Generally Accepted Accounting Practice (United Kingdom Accounting Standards and applicable law).

Under Company law the directors must not approve the financial statements unless they are satisfied that they give a true and fair view of the state of affairs of the Company and of the profit or loss of the Company for that period.

In preparing those financial statements, the directors are required to:

a. select suitable accounting policies and then apply them consistently;

b. make judgements and accounting estimates that are reasonable and prudent;

c. state whether applicable UK Accounting Standards have been followed, subject to any material departures disclosed and explained in the financial statements; and

d. prepare the financial statements on the going concern basis unless it is inappropriate to presume that the Company will continue in business.

The directors are responsible for keeping adequate accounting records that are sufficient to show and explain the Company's transactions and disclose with reasonable accuracy at any time the financial position of the Company and enable them to ensure that the financial statements comply with the Companies Act 2006. They are also responsible for safeguarding the assets of the Company and hence for taking reasonable steps for the prevention and detection of fraud and other irregularities.

INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S REPORT TO THE MEMBERS OF STOKE CITY FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

Opinion

We have audited the financial statements of Stoke City Football Club Limited (the 'company') for the year ended 31 May 2025 which comprise the statement of total income and retained earnings, the statement of financial position and notes to the financial statements, including significant accounting policies. The financial reporting framework that has been applied in their preparation is applicable law and United Kingdom Accounting Standards, including FRS 102 "The Financial Reporting Standard applicable in the UK and Republic of Ireland" (United Kingdom Generally Accepted Accounting Practice).

In our opinion, the financial statements:

- give a true and fair view of the state of the company's affairs as at 31 May 2025 and of its loss for the year then ended;
- have been properly prepared in accordance with United Kingdom Generally Accepted Accounting Practice;
- have been prepared in accordance with the requirements of the Companies Act 2006.

Basis for opinion

We conducted our audit in accordance with International Standards on Auditing (UK) (ISAs (UK)) and applicable law. Our responsibilities under those standards are further described in the Auditor's responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements section of our report. We are independent of the company in accordance with the ethical requirements that are relevant to our audit of the financial statements in the UK, including the FRC's Ethical Standard, and we have fulfilled our other ethical responsibilities in accordance with these requirements. We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion.

Conclusions relating to going concern

In auditing the financial statements, we have concluded that the Directors' use of the going concern basis of accounting in the preparation of the financial statements is appropriate.

Based on the work we have performed, we have not identified any material uncertainties relating to events or conditions that, individually or collectively, may cast significant doubt on the company's ability to continue as a going concern for a period of at least twelve months from when the financial statements are authorised for issue.

Our responsibilities and the responsibilities of the Directors with respect to going concern are described in the relevant sections of this report.

Other information

The other information comprises the information included in the annual report, other than the financial statements and our auditor's report thereon. The directors are responsible for the other information contained within the annual report. Our opinion on the financial statements does not cover the other information and, except to the extent otherwise explicitly stated in our report, we do not express any form of assurance conclusion thereon.

Our responsibility is to read the other information and, in doing so, consider whether the other information is materially inconsistent with the financial statements or our knowledge obtained in the course of the audit or otherwise appears to be materially misstated. If we identify such material inconsistencies or apparent material misstatements, we are required to determine whether this gives rise to a material misstatement in the financial statements themselves. If, based on the work we have performed, we conclude that there is a material misstatement of this other information, we are required to report that fact.

We have nothing to report in this regard.

Opinions on other matters prescribed by the Companies Act 2006
In our opinion, based on the work undertaken in the course of the audit:

- the information given in the strategic report and the Directors' report for the financial year for which the financial statements are prepared is consistent with the financial statements; and
- the strategic report and the Directors' report have been prepared in accordance with applicable legal requirements.

Matters on which we are required to report by exception
In the light of the knowledge and understanding of the company and its environment obtained in the course of the audit, we have not identified material misstatements in the strategic report and the Directors' report.

We have nothing to report in respect of the following matters in relation to which the Companies Act 2006 requires us to report to you if, in our opinion:

- adequate accounting records have not been kept, or returns adequate for our audit have not been received from branches not visited by us; or
- the financial statements are not in agreement with the accounting records and returns; or
- certain disclosures of Directors' remuneration specified by law are not made; or
- we have not received all the information and explanations we require for our audit.

Responsibilities of Directors
As explained more fully in the Directors' responsibilities statement set out on page 10, the Directors are responsible for the preparation of the financial statements and for being satisfied that they give a true and fair view, and for such internal control as the Directors determine is necessary to enable the preparation of financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

In preparing the financial statements, the Directors are responsible for assessing the company's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern and using the going concern basis of accounting unless the Directors either intend to liquidate the company or to cease operations, or have no realistic alternative but to do so.

Auditor's responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements
Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue an auditor's report that includes our opinion. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance, but is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with ISAs (UK) will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. Misstatements can arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of these financial statements.

The extent to which the audit was considered capable of detecting irregularities, including fraud
Irregularities are instances of non-compliance with laws and regulations. The objectives of our audit are to obtain sufficient appropriate audit evidence regarding compliance with laws and regulations that have a direct effect on the determination of material amounts and disclosures in the financial statements, to perform audit procedures to help identify instances of non-compliance with other laws and regulations that may have a material effect on the financial statements, and to respond appropriately to identified or suspected non-compliance with laws and regulations identified during the audit.

In relation to fraud, the objectives of our audit are to identify and assess the risk of material misstatement of the financial statements due to fraud, to obtain sufficient appropriate audit evidence regarding the assessed risks of material misstatement due to fraud through designing and implementing appropriate responses and to respond appropriately to fraud or suspected fraud identified during the audit.

However, it is the primary responsibility of management, with the oversight of those charged with governance, to ensure that the entity's operations are conducted in accordance with the provisions of laws and regulations and for the prevention and detection of fraud.

In identifying and assessing risks of material misstatement in respect of irregularities, including fraud, the audit engagement team:

- obtained an understanding of the nature of the industry and sector, including the legal and regulatory frameworks that the company operates in and how the company is complying with the legal and regulatory frameworks;
- inquired of management, and those charged with governance, about their own identification and assessment of the risks of irregularities, including any known actual, suspected or alleged instances of fraud;
- discussed matters about non-compliance with laws and regulations and how fraud might occur including assessment of how and where the financial statements may be susceptible to fraud.

As a result of these procedures we consider the most significant laws and regulations that have a direct impact on the financial statements are FRS 102, the Companies Act 2006 and tax compliance regulations. We performed audit procedures to detect non-compliances which may have a material impact on the financial statements which included reviewing financial statement disclosures, inspecting correspondence with local tax authorities and evaluating advice, where applicable, received from internal tax advisors.

The most significant laws and regulations that have an indirect impact on the financial statements are those in relation to compliance with Football regulation, at a Football Association level and with the English Football League. We performed audit procedures to inquire of management whether the Company is in compliance with these laws and regulations and inspected correspondence with regulatory authorities.

The audit engagement team identified the risk of management override of controls as the area where the financial statements were most susceptible to material misstatement due to fraud. Audit procedures performed included but were not limited to testing manual journal entries and other adjustments and evaluating the business rationale in relation to significant, unusual transactions and transactions entered into outside the normal course of business.

A further description of our responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements is located on the Financial Reporting Council's website at: http://www.frc.org.uk/auditorsresponsibilities. This description forms part of our auditor's report.

Use of our report

This report is made solely to the company's members, as a body, in accordance with Chapter 3 of Part 16 of the Companies Act 2006. Our audit work has been undertaken so that we might state to the company's members those matters we are required to state to them in an auditor's report and for no other purpose. To the fullest extent permitted by law, we do not accept or assume responsibility to anyone other than the company and the company's members as a body, for our audit work, for this report, or for the opinions we have formed.

Adam Krupski

ADAM KRUPSKI (Senior Statutory Auditor)
For and on behalf of RSM UK AUDIT LLP, Statutory Auditor
Chartered Accountants
Festival Way
Stoke-on-Trent
Staffordshire
ST1 5BB

24/12/25

Stoke City Football Club Limited

STATEMENT OF TOTAL INCOME AND RETAINED EARNINGS

For the year ended 31 May 2025

	Note	2025 Operations excluding player trading £000	2025 Player trading (note 6) £000	2025 Total £000	2024 £000
TURNOVER	2	**35,438**	**-**	**35,438**	32,271
Operating expenses		**(57,644)**	**(7,499)**	**(65,143)**	(62,982)
		(22,206)	**(7,499)**	**(29,705)**	(30,711)
Profit on disposal of players' registrations	6	**-**	**151**	**151**	4,408
Profit on disposal of fixed assets		**17**	**-**	**17**	67
OPERATING LOSS		**(22,189)**	**(7,348)**	**(29,537)**	(26,236)
Interest receivable and similar income	3	**1,230**	**-**	**1,230**	374
LOSS BEFORE TAXATION	2-6	**(20,959)**	**(7,348)**	**(28,307)**	(25,862)
Taxation	7	**3,121**	**704**	**3,825**	(2,764)
LOSS AFTER TAX FOR THE YEAR				**(24,482)**	(28,626)
RETAINED EARNINGS AT 1 JUNE				**(168,904)**	(140,278)
RETAINED EARNINGS AT 31 MAY				**(193,386)**	(168,904)

Stoke City Football Club Limited

STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION
At 31 May 2025

	Notes	2025		2024	
		£000	£000	£000	£000
FIXED ASSETS					
Intangible assets	8		**11,650**		14,072
Tangible assets	9		**669**		579
			12,319		14,651
CURRENT ASSETS					
Stocks	10	**1,090**		853	
Debtors (due after more than one year £nil (2024: £6,780,000))	11	**9,674**		15,438	
Cash at bank and in hand		**25,522**		6,940	
		36,286		23,231	
CREDITORS: Amounts falling due within one year	12	**(204,246)**		(167,437)	
NET CURRENT LIABILITIES			**(167,960)**		(144,206)
TOTAL ASSETS LESS CURRENT LIABILITIES			**(155,641)**		(129,555)
CREDITORS: Amounts falling due after more than one year	13		**(528)**		(1)
PROVISIONS FOR LIABILITIES	14		**(796)**		(2,927)
NET LIABILITIES			**(156,965)**		(132,483)
CAPITAL AND RESERVES					
Called up share capital	15		**35,842**		35,842
Share premium account			**579**		579
Profit and loss reserve			**(193,386)**		(168,904)
TOTAL EQUITY			**(156,965)**		(132,483)

The financial statements on pages 14 to 31 were approved by the board of directors and authorised for issue on 24/12/25 and are signed on its behalf by:

John Coates
Chair

Company Registration No.00099885

GENERAL INFORMATION
Stoke City Football Club Limited ("the Company" or "the Club") is a private company limited by shares and is registered, domiciled and incorporated in England.

The address of the Company's registered office and principal place of business is bet365 Stadium, Stanley Matthews Way, Stoke-on-Trent, Staffordshire, ST4 4EG.

The Company's principal activities and nature of its operations are included in the Directors' Report.

BASIS OF ACCOUNTING
These financial statements are prepared in accordance with Financial Reporting Standard 102 'The Financial Reporting Standard applicable in the UK and Republic of Ireland' (FRS 102) and the requirements of the Companies Act 2006, including the provisions of the Large and Medium-sized Companies and Groups (Accounts and Reports) Regulations 2008, and under the historical cost convention unless otherwise identified.

Monetary amounts in these financial statements are rounded to the nearest whole £1,000, except where otherwise indicated.

REDUCED DISCLOSURES
In accordance with FRS 102, the Company has taken advantage of the exemptions from the following disclosure requirements:

- Section 7 'Cash Flow Statements'
- Section 33 'Related Party Disclosures' – Compensation for key management personnel.

The financial statements of the Company are consolidated in the financial statements of Stoke City Holdings Limited. Details of where these accounts are available have been disclosed in note 20.

GOING CONCERN
The Company prepares detailed forecasts each financial year taking into account the risks and uncertainties as detailed in the Strategic Report.

The financial statements therefore have been prepared on a going concern basis as the Company's ultimate owner, John Coates, has agreed to continue to support the Company's funding requirements to enable the Company to meet its obligations as they fall due for 12 months from the date of signing these financial statements. As a result of this undertaking, and consideration of the owner's ability to provide appropriate support, the directors consider it appropriate to prepare the financial statements on a going concern basis.

FUNCTIONAL AND PRESENTATIONAL CURRENCIES
The financial statements are presented in sterling which is also the functional currency of the Company.

FOREIGN CURRENCIES
Transactions in currencies other than the functional currency are initially recorded at the exchange rate prevailing on the date of the transaction. Monetary assets and liabilities denominated in foreign currencies are translated at the rate of exchange ruling at the reporting date. Non-monetary assets and liabilities denominated in foreign currencies are translated at the rate ruling at the date of the transaction or, if the asset or liability is measured at fair value, the rate when that fair value was determined.

All translation differences are taken to the income statement.

TURNOVER
Turnover, exclusive of value added tax, comprises net match receipts and League receipts and other income arising from the Company's activities. Revenue is recognised when substantially all of the obligations under a sales contract have been fulfilled. Revenue received from the League is recognised in the financial statements based on games played in the season. This is in accordance with the League guidelines on income recognition. Performance related rewards are not recognised until achieved by the Club, as the income cannot be assumed with certainty.

OTHER INCOME
Interest income is accrued on a time-apportioned basis, by reference to the principal outstanding at the effective interest rate.

INTANGIBLE FIXED ASSETS
The third party costs associated with the acquisition of players' registrations and coaching staff are capitalised and amortised to zero on a straight line basis over the period of their respective contracts. A full year of amortisation is recognised in the year the cost is capitalised. Any transfer fees payable as a result of the occurrence of one or more uncertain future events are capitalised when it is probable such an event will occur. Provision for impairment is made when it becomes clear that the carrying amount exceeds the recoverable amount. No amounts are included for the registrations attributable to players developed within the Club.

TANGIBLE FIXED ASSETS
Tangible fixed assets are stated at cost, net of depreciation and any provision for impairment.

Depreciation is provided on all tangible fixed assets at rates calculated to write each asset down to its estimated residual value evenly over its expected useful life, as follows:

Plant and equipment	-	8 – 33% per annum straight line
Motor vehicles	-	25% per annum straight line

Residual value is calculated on prices prevailing at the reporting date, after estimated costs of disposal for the asset as if it were at the age and in the condition expected at the end of its useful life.

DEFERRED INCOME
Deferred income consists of season tickets, sponsorship and other elements of income which have been received prior to the year end in respect of future football seasons.

STOCK
Stocks are valued at the lower of cost and estimated selling price less costs to sell. Cost is determined using the weighted average cost basis.

At each reporting date, the Company assesses whether stocks are impaired or if an impairment loss recognised in prior periods has reversed. Any excess of the carrying amount of stock over its estimated selling price less costs to complete and sell is recognised as an impairment loss in profit or loss. Reversals of impairment losses are also recognised in profit or loss.

SIGNING ON FEES AND LOYALTY BONUSES
The directors consider that signing on fees represent a normal part of the employment cost of players and the manager and as such should be charged to the income statement evenly over the period of the players' and managers' contract. At the time of a player disposal any excess signing on fees accrued or paid but not recognised are allocated in full against the profit on disposal of players' registrations in the year in which the player disposal is made.

Loyalty bonuses are recognised as an expense when all the conditions relating to the loyalty bonus are met.

TAXATION
The tax expense represents the sum of the current tax expense and deferred tax expense. Current tax assets are recognised when tax paid exceeds the tax payable.

Current tax is based on taxable profit for the year. Taxable profit differs from total comprehensive income because it excludes items of income or expense that are taxable or deductible in other periods and because it includes items of income or expense that are never taxable or deductible for tax purposes. Current tax assets and liabilities are measured using tax rates that have been enacted or substantively enacted by the reporting date.

Deferred tax is calculated at the tax rates that are expected to apply to the period when the asset is realised or the liability is settled based on tax rates that have been enacted or substantively enacted by the reporting date. Deferred tax is not discounted.

Deferred tax liabilities are recognised in respect of all timing differences that exist at the reporting date. Timing differences are differences between taxable profits and total comprehensive income that arise from the inclusion of income and expenses in tax assessments in different periods from their recognition in the financial statements. Deferred tax assets are recognised only to the extent that it is probable that they will be recovered by the reversal of deferred tax liabilities or other future taxable profits.

Current and deferred tax is charged or credited in the profit and loss account, except when it relates to items charged or credited to other comprehensive income or equity, when the tax follows the transaction or event it relates to and is also charged or credited to other comprehensive income, or equity.

Current tax assets and current tax liabilities and deferred tax assets and deferred tax liabilities are offset, if and only if, there is a legally enforceable right to set off the amounts and the entity intends either to settle on a net basis or to realise the asset and settle the liability simultaneously.

LEASES
All leases are operating leases and the annual rentals are charged to the profit and loss account on a straight line basis over the lease term.

PROVISIONS
Provisions are recognised when the Company has a present legal or constructive obligation as a result of past events, it is probable that an outflow of resources will be required to settle the obligation; and the amount of the obligation can be estimated reliably.

RESERVES
Share Premium
Consideration received for shares issued above their nominal value net of transaction costs.

Profit and loss account
Cumulative profit and loss net of distributions to owners.

EMPLOYEE BENEFITS AND COSTS
Accumulated compensated absences accrual arises when employees render services that give rise to their entitlement to future compensated absences that have not been taken at the period end. The cost accrued is the amount that would be expected to be paid as a result of the unused entitlement.

RETIREMENT BENEFITS
Certain employees of the Club participate in the Football League Limited Pension and Life Assurance Scheme and the Football League Limited Players' Benefit Scheme. Both schemes are defined benefit schemes co-sponsored by the FA Premier League and the Football League. The Club makes contributions to the schemes in accordance with the recommendations of the actuaries to the schemes.

RETIREMENT BENEFITS (CONTINUED)
The Club is one of a number of participating employers in the schemes and it is not possible to allocate part of any actuarial rights or deficit owing to the Club's employees only their share of contributions payable to the scheme. Consequently, contributions paid in the period and any movement in the Club's share of contributions, net of payments made are charged to the profit and loss account. The differences between contributions payable in the period and contributions actually paid are shown as either accruals or prepayments in the balance sheet. The Club's share of future contributions to be paid to the scheme, as advised by the actuary, is recognised as a provision in the financial statements.

Contributions are also paid to individuals' money purchase pension schemes. The contributions are charged to the income statement in the period in which they become payable. The assets of all the pension schemes are held separately from those of the Club in independently administered funds.

FINANCIAL INSTRUMENTS
The Company has elected to apply the provisions of Section 11 'Basic Financial Instruments' and Section 12 'Other Financial Instruments Issues' of FRS 102, in full, to all of its financial instruments.

Financial assets and financial liabilities are recognised when the Company becomes a party to the contractual provisions of the instrument, and are offset only when the Company currently has a legally enforceable right to set off the recognised amounts and intends either to settle on a net basis, or to realise the asset and settle the liability simultaneously.

Financial assets
Trade debtors, group balances and other debtors
Trade debtors, group and other debtors which are receivable within one year are initially measured at the transaction price. The debtors are subsequently measured at amortised cost, being the transaction price less any amounts settled and any impairment losses.

A provision for impairment of trade debtor, group and other debtors is established when there is objective evidence that the amounts due will not be collected according to the original terms of the contract.

Impairment losses are recognised in the profit and loss account for the excess of the carrying value of the debtor over the present value of the future cash flows discounted using the original effective interest rate.

Subsequent reversals of an impairment loss that objectively relate to an event occurring after the impairment loss was recognised, are recognised immediately in the income statement.

Financial liabilities or equity instruments
Financial instruments are classified as liabilities and equity instruments according to the substance of the contractual arrangements entered into. An equity instrument is any contract that evidences a residual interest in the assets of the Company after deducting all its liabilities.

Borrowings – Funding group balances
Borrowings are initially measured at the transaction price, including transaction costs, and subsequently measured at amortised cost using the effective interest method. Interest expense is recognised on the basis of the effective interest method and is included in interest payable and other similar charges. No interest is currently charged on these balances.

Equity instruments
Financial instruments classified as equity instruments are recorded at the fair value of the cash or other resources received or receivable, net of direct costs of issuing the equity instruments.

Preference shares
Dividends on preference shares classified as liabilities are presented within interest payable and similar charges.

FINANCIAL INSTRUMENTS (CONTINUED)

Trade creditors, group balances and other creditors

Trade, group and other creditors payable within one year are initially measured at the transaction price and subsequently measured at amortised cost, being the transaction price less any amounts settled.

Derecognition of financial assets and liabilities

A financial asset is derecognised only when the contractual rights to cash flows expire or are settled, or substantially all the risks and rewards of ownership are transferred to another party, or if some significant risks and rewards of ownership are retained but control of the asset has transferred to another party that is able to sell the asset in its entirety to an unrelated third party. A financial liability (or part thereof) is derecognised when the obligation specified in the contract is discharged, cancelled or expires.

1 CRITICAL ACCOUNTING ESTIMATES AND AREAS OF JUDGEMENT

Estimates, judgements and assumptions
The Company makes estimates and assumptions concerning the future. The resulting accounting estimates and assumptions will, by definition, seldom equal the related actual results. The directors consider there are no estimates, judgements and assumptions that have a significant risk of causing a material adjustment to the carrying amounts of assets and liabilities within the next financial year.

2 TURNOVER

Turnover, all of which arises from the Company's principal activity and derived solely from the United Kingdom, can be analysed into its main components as follows:

	2025	2024
	£000	£000
Gate receipts	**5,740**	5,732
Sponsorship and advertising	**10,281**	10,077
Television and media	**11,902**	9,835
Conferencing and hospitality	**3,597**	2,938
Other operating income	**3,918**	3,689
	35,438	32,271

Details for the current period of turnover and profit by class of business is given in the profit and loss account and comparative information for the year ended 31 May 2024 is shown below:

COMPREHENSIVE INCOME BREAKDOWN	Year ended 31 May 2024		
	Operations excluding player trading	Player trading	Total
	£000	£000	£000
Turnover	32,271	-	32,271
Operating expenses	(56,638)	(6,344)	(62,982)
	(24,367)	(6,344)	(30,711)
Profit on disposal of player registrations	-	4,408	4,408
Profit on disposal of fixed assets	67	-	67
Operating loss	(24,300)	(1,936)	(26,236)

3 INTEREST RECEIVABLE AND SIMILAR INCOME

	2025 £000	2024 £000
Bank interest	**1,230**	374

4 LOSS BEFORE TAXATION

	2025 £000	2024 £000
Loss before taxation is stated after charging/(crediting):		
Depreciation and amounts written off tangible fixed assets:		
Charge for the year:		
Owned assets	**323**	235
Amortisation of intangible fixed assets	**6,807**	6,344
Impairment of intangible fixed assets	**692**	-
Operating lease rentals:		
Land and buildings	**4,226**	4,719
Exchange profits	**(27)**	(46)
Profit on disposal of fixed assets	**(17)**	(67)
Audit services:		
Statutory audit	**33**	33
Audit-related assurance services	**14**	14
	47	47

5 EMPLOYEES

	2025 Number	2024 Number
The average monthly number of persons (including directors) employed by the Company during the year was:		
Full time playing staff and scholars	**103**	90
Other	**229**	209
	332	299

5 EMPLOYEES (CONTINUED)

	2025 £000	2024 £000
Staff costs for the above persons:		
Wages and salaries	**26,513**	27,775
Social security costs	**3,507**	3,735
Other pension costs	**280**	254
	30,300	31,764

DIRECTOR'S REMUNERATION AND HIGHEST PAID DIRECTOR	2025 £000	2024 £000
Emoluments	-	-

The number of directors to whom relevant benefits were accruing under money purchase pension schemes was nil (2024: nil).

The remuneration of the Directors is paid by a related party, a former parent group company.

6 PLAYER TRADING

	2025 £000	2024 £000
Amortisation of intangible fixed assets	**(6,807)**	(6,344)
Impairment of intangible fixed assets	**(692)**	-
Profit on disposal of players' registrations	**151**	4,408
	(7,348)	(1,936)

7 TAXATION

	2025 £000	2024 £000
Current tax		
UK corporation tax	**(1,061)**	-
	(1,061)	-
Deferred taxation:		
Origination and reversal of timing differences	**(3,329)**	(591)
Recognition of unprovided deferred tax	**-**	3,355
Adjustment in respect of prior years	**565**	-
	(2,764)	2,764
Tax on loss	**(3,825)**	2,764

Factors affecting tax charge for the year:

The tax assessed for the year is lower (2024: higher) than the effective rate of corporation tax in the UK of 25% (2024: 25%) applied to the loss for the year. The differences are explained below:

Loss before taxation	**(28,307)**	(25,862)
Loss multiplied by the effective rate of corporation tax in the UK of 25% (2024: 25%)	**(7,077)**	(6,465)
Effects of:		
Expenses not deductible for tax purposes	**7**	21
Transfer pricing adjustment	**(150)**	(148)
Group relief	**540**	6,001
Prior year adjustments	**565**	-
Movement in deferred tax not recognised	**2,290**	3,355
Total tax (credit)/charge for the year	**(3,825)**	2,764

8 INTANGIBLE FIXED ASSETS

	Players' registrations £000
Cost	
At beginning of year	23,989
Additions	7,329
Disposals	(5,616)
At end of year	25,702
Amortisation	
At beginning of year	9,917
Charge for year	6,807
Impairment	692
Disposals	(3,364)
At end of year	14,052
Carrying amount	
At 31 May 2025	**11,650**
At 31 May 2024	14,072

The amortisation charge and impairment loss for the year of player registrations is recognised within operating expenses. A provision for impairment has been made where the carrying amount has been deemed to exceed the recoverable amount.

The carrying amount players' and manager registrations of £11,650,000 (2024: £14,072,000) has a remaining amortisation period of up to 3 years (2024: up to 3 years).

9 TANGIBLE FIXED ASSETS

	Plant, equipment and motor vehicles £000
Cost	
At beginning of year	2,000
Additions	539
Disposals	(233)
At end of year	2,306
Depreciation	
At beginning of year	1,421
Charge for year	323
Disposals	(107)
At end of year	1,637
Carrying amount	
At 31 May 2025	**669**
At 31 May 2024	579

10 STOCKS

	2025	2024
	£000	£000
Goods for resale	**1,090**	853

11 DEBTORS

	2025	2024
	£000	£000
Amounts falling due within one year:		
Trade debtors	**8,884**	7,742
Other debtors	**147**	149
Prepayments and accrued income	**643**	767
	9,674	8,658
Amounts falling due in more than one year:		
Trade debtors	-	6,780
	9,674	15,438

12 CREDITORS: Amounts falling due within one year

	2025	2024
	£000	£000
Trade creditors	**3,229**	3,940
Amounts owed to group undertakings	**191,203**	151,009
Other taxation and social security costs	**1,738**	2,053
Accruals and deferred income	**8,076**	10,435
	204,246	167,437

Although repayable on demand, the group undertakings have confirmed they will only request repayment of the amounts owed in respect of long term funding when the Company has resources to repay the debt.

13 CREDITORS: Amounts falling due after more than one year

	2025	2024
	£000	£000
Trade creditors	**527**	-
Preference shares of £1 each (see note 15)	**1**	1
	528	1

14 PROVISIONS FOR LIABILITIES

	Deferred taxation £000	Onerous contract £000	Pension obligations £000	Total £000
Balance at beginning of year	2,764	80	83	2,927
(Credit)/charge in the year	(2,764)	751	-	(2,013)
Paid in the year	-	(80)	(38)	(118)
Balance at end of year	**-**	**751**	**45**	796

Pension obligations

Certain staff of the Company are members of either the Football League Limited Retirement Income Scheme, a defined benefit scheme, or the Football League Limited Pension and Life Assurance Scheme ("FLLPLAS"), a defined benefit scheme.

There is insufficient information to account for the scheme as a defined benefit plan, so it is accounted for as a defined contribution plan.

At 1 September 2023, a Minimum Funding Requirement ("MFR") deficit was identified in the scheme, of which a proportion was allocated to Stoke City Football Club Limited. Contributions have continued to be paid during the year, as advised by the actuary, resulting in a provision relating to the Club's share of the MFR deficit of £45,000 at the year end (2024: £83,000). The Company expects to make contributions of £38,000 in the next accounting period.

In addition to the above the Company also contributes to a defined contribution scheme and makes contributions to employees' personal pension plans.

Contributions to all pension schemes totalling £351,000 (2024: £254,000) were paid to the various schemes in the year. At the year end £47,000 (2023: £35,000) relating to unpaid contributions were included in accruals and deferred income. These amounts were paid in June 2025.

Deferred taxation

The elements of the deferred liability and amounts not provided are as follows:

	2025		2024	
	Provided £000	**Unprovided £000**	Provided £000	Unprovided £000
Fixed asset timing differences	**2,121**	**-**	2,816	-
Other timing differences	**(42)**	**-**	(52)	-
Losses	**(2,079)**	**(2,290)**	-	-
	-	**(2,290)**	2,764	-

14 PROVISIONS FOR LIABILITIES (CONTINUED)

Onerous contracts
The onerous employment contracts provision in respect of the Club is recognised for contracts under which the unavoidable costs of meeting the obligations under the contracts exceed the economic benefits expected to be received under them.

The onerous employment contracts provision is expected to be utilised over the next twelve months.

15 SHARE CAPITAL

	2025	2024
	£000	£000
Allotted and called up:		
35,690,321 Ordinary shares of £1 each	**35,690**	35,690
64,000 Ordinary I shares of £1 each	**64**	64
88,023 Ordinary Y shares of £1 each	**88**	88
1 Ordinary W shares of £1 each	**-**	-
Equity shareholders	**35,842**	35,842
Non-Equity: preference shares of £1 each	**1**	1
Cumulative preference A Shares of £1 each	**-**	-
Cumulative preference B shares of £1 each	**-**	-
	1	1

The I, Y and W ordinary shares attach various voting rights, in all other respects the shares rank pari passu. The preference shares are non-redeemable and carry no interest coupon.

16 COMMITMENTS UNDER OPERATING LEASES

The total future minimum lease payments under non-cancellable operating leases is as follows:

	2025	2024
	£000	£000
Amounts due within one year	**4,610**	4,635
Amounts due between one and five years	**18,440**	18,444
Amounts due in more than five years	**73,760**	78,370
	96,810	101,449

Of the above commitments the majority relate to the lease of the football Stadium and Training Ground.

17 CONTINGENT LIABILITIES AND ASSETS

As at the year end the directors review the existing and former player contracts to determine if contingent liabilities or contingent assets exist from transfer fees payable and receivable. A degree of estimation is required in this assessment to establish the level of disclosure to make. Provisions are made once certainty of outcome has been achieved. Contingent liabilities and assets are assessed based on outcomes being achievable rather than actually achieved.

Additional fees under these contracts that may therefore be payable or receivable if certain conditions are met in the future, such as promotion to the Premier League and activities of other football clubs, have been assessed by the directors at the year end date as a maximum net liability of £11,469,000 (2024: £11,713,000).

18 RELATED PARTY TRANSACTIONS

During the financial year the Company had the following transactions with related parties:

		2025		*2024*	
Description of relationship	*Description of transactions*	***Aggregate value for financial year***	***Net amount owed to / (by) the company***	*Aggregate value for financial year*	*Net amount owed to / (by) the company*
		£000	**£000**	£000	£000
Entities under common control	Purchases and other charges	**(13,464)**	**(46,338)**	(16,449)	(46,751)
	Sales and other income	**9,088**	**4**	9,158	16
	Loans received	**46,000**	**(144,865)**	12,000	(104,258)
Other related parties	Sales and other income	**864**	**207**	668	177

The gross amount due to Stoke City Holdings Limited at the year end was £144,865,000 (2024: £104,258,000).

19 POST BALANCE SHEET EVENTS

Subsequent to the year end, the Company has acquired and committed to acquire player registrations at an initial cost of £11,356,000 (2024: £5,125,000). The Company has also realised £7,346,000 (2024: £77,000) on the disposal of player registrations and whose net book value at the year end was £3,381,000 (2024: £1,760,000).

20 ULTIMATE CONTROLLING PARTY

The ultimate parent company of Stoke City Football Club Limited at the year end was Stoke City Holdings Limited, a Company incorporated and registered in the UK.

The consolidated financial statements of Stoke City Holdings Limited are available to the public and may be obtained from:

Registrar of Companies
Crown Way
CARDIFF
CF14 3UZ

On 8 July 2024 all shares in Stoke City Holdings Limited and its subsidiaries were demerged from bet365 Group Limited to John Coates, who is now the ultimate controlling party.